

BOMB DEFUSAL SQUAD

FIELD REFERENCE MANUAL

Revision 7.3 — Authorized Operational Use Only

Improper interpretation of procedural documentation may result in device detonation, disciplinary review, or both.

This document is intended for dual-operator use only.
Read every clause in the order presented.

MODULE 1 — THE TIMER

The Timer Display provides a continuously decrementing chronological value representing the remaining operational duration of the device prior to detonation. The displayed value shall be treated as authoritative for every temporal reference made elsewhere in this manual, including references appearing in sections whose subject matter is not, in ordinary language, temporal in character.

The display format shall appear as MM:SS, wherein MM denotes remaining minutes and SS denotes remaining seconds. The colon is a separator only; it is not, and shall not be treated as, a decimal marker, arithmetic symbol, or visual ornament.

1.1 DIGIT IDENTIFICATION

1.1.1 Last Digit. The phrase last digit shall mean the rightmost numeric character presently visible on the timer display; stated differently, it is the units position of the seconds field and not the entire seconds field taken as a two-digit number.

Formal expression: Last Digit = SS mod 10.

1.1.2 Contains Digit. A timer shall be said to contain a digit when any one or more of the four visible numeric positions of the MM:SS display matches the numeral under consideration. A numeral appearing more than once does not create multiple conditions unless another module explicitly counts occurrences.

1.1.3 Positional Scope. Unless a section expressly limits inspection to seconds, minutes, rightmost positions, or another named subset, every visible numeric position of the display is in scope for the phrase any digit of the timer.

1.2 EXAMPLE TIMER INTERPRETATIONS

Timer Reading	Minutes Digits	Seconds Digits	Last Digit	Digits Contained
05:41	0, 5	4, 1	1	0, 1, 4, 5
02:08	0, 2	0, 8	8	0, 2, 8
00:37	0, 0	3, 7	7	0, 3, 7
11:20	1, 1	2, 0	0	0, 1, 2
09:14	0, 9	1, 4	4	0, 1, 4, 9

1.3 INTERPRETATION CAUTION

WARNING. Operators shall not confuse the seconds value with the full timestamp, nor the seconds value with the last digit. For example, at 02:14 the full timestamp is 02:14, the seconds value is 14, and the last digit is 4. Any rule referring to the last digit refers to 4 and to nothing larger than a single numeral.

1.4 FOOTNOTE

[1] See Incident Log B-22, concerning an avoidable training detonation caused by improper substitution of the value fourteen where the rule required only the numeral four.

MODULE 2 — WIRES

Six wires are present in a fixed indexed order. Index numbering begins at zero and proceeds consecutively to five. For avoidance of ambiguity, the standard arrangement addressed by this section is not variable and shall be read exactly as set out below.

Index	Colour
0	Red
1	Blue
2	Yellow
3	White
4	Black
5	Red

2.1 DEFINITIONS

2.1.1 Last Digit. The phrase last digit bears the meaning assigned in Section 1.1.1 and shall not be redefined locally.

2.1.2 Last Wire. The phrase last wire means the wire occupying the highest index position on the module. In the present layout, the last wire is therefore the wire at index 5.

2.1.3 Cut. The verb cut means to sever the conductive body of the selected wire such that electrical continuity is irreversibly interrupted. Compression, indentation, cosmetic scoring of insulation, or bending without separation shall not constitute a cut.

2.2 FLOWCHART-STYLE DECISION PROCEDURE

The operator shall evaluate the following clauses in strict order and shall apply the FIRST matching rule only. Once a rule has matched, later clauses are procedurally irrelevant even if they might also describe the present arrangement. The decision structure is therefore sequential rather than cumulative, notwithstanding any superficial overlap between conditions.

2.2.1 Begin by determining whether the timer's last digit is odd and whether the module contains two or more wires classified as red. If both propositions are true, terminate all further analysis and cut the last red wire; in the standard layout this is the red wire at index 5.

2.2.2 If, and only if, Clause 2.2.1 does not apply, determine whether the last wire is black and whether the timer's last digit is even. If both propositions are true, cut the wire at index 5.

2.2.3 If neither Clause 2.2.1 nor Clause 2.2.2 applies, determine whether there is exactly one blue wire. If that condition is satisfied, cut the wire at index 1.

2.2.4 If no prior clause has matched, the residual instruction applies by default and the operator shall cut the wire at index 2.

2.3 NOTE ON INSULATION APPEARANCE

Under fluorescent, sodium-vapour, emergency, or other operational lighting conditions, the visible insulation colour of certain wires may present with a shifted hue, reduced saturation, or misleading reflectance. This observation, while occasionally remarked upon in maintenance bulletins, is not decision-relevant. Classification remains as manufactured, not as theatrically perceived.

2.4 CROSS-REFERENCE

Reference to the timer for odd/even determination shall be made in accordance with Section 1.1.1 and subject to the warning stated in Section 1.3.[1]

MODULE 3 — THE BUTTON

The Button Module consists of a single coloured button whose operative handling depends upon a colour-based determination made prior to actuation. Recognised button colours for purposes of this section are Red, Blue, Yellow, and White. No other visible feature overrides the colour classification established by the button face itself.

3.1 HOLD vs TAP DETERMINATION

3.1.1 Valid Hold. A hold is constituted when the button is depressed and maintained in an uninterrupted depressed state for a duration exceeding 0.5 seconds. A press intended as a tap but lasting longer than this threshold shall, for compliance purposes, be treated as a hold regardless of operator intention.

3.1.2 Valid Tap. A tap is constituted when the button is depressed and released in under 0.5 seconds. The release completes the action; continued pressure beyond the threshold converts the interaction into a hold.

3.1.3 Timing Reference. Where a hold is required, the release moment shall be selected by reference to the timer display and not by internal counting, estimation, or informal verbal cadence.

3.2 PRIMARY MULTI-CLAUSE PROCEDURE

3.2.1 If the button colour is Blue, then the operator shall initiate a valid hold and shall continue holding until any digit of the timer equals 4, at which moment the button shall be released without gratuitous delay.

3.2.2 If the button colour is Red, then the operator shall initiate a valid hold and shall continue holding until any digit of the timer equals 1, at which moment the button shall be released without gratuitous delay.

3.2.3 If the button colour is Yellow or White, then the operator shall execute a valid tap, meaning release must occur in under 0.5 seconds and no digit-inspection release condition is to be awaited.

3.3 DIGIT MATCH CRITERION

The phrase any digit of the timer equals X shall mean that any one of the four visible numeric positions may satisfy the condition. Thus, at 03:41, both the numeral 4 and the numeral 1 are present and a hold conditioned upon either numeral may be released at once.

3.4 FOOTNOTE

[2] Some units include a so-called strip colour indicator adjacent to the button assembly. The illuminated strip merely confirms the button colour already visible to the operator and conveys no supplementary procedural information.

MODULE 4 — KEYPAD

The Keypad Module presents four keys, each bearing a symbol. Exactly one press sequence is correct. The correct sequence is not inferred from the physical arrangement of the keys themselves but from a lookup operation against the approved symbol columns appearing in this section. The Expert, who observes the reference order on a separate interface, shall communicate that order to the Defuser with sufficient precision to prevent shape confusion.

4.1 SYMBOL IDENTIFICATION STANDARD

Symbols shall be identified by shape only. Colour, brightness, surface glow, background shading, or monitor calibration are not reliable discriminators and may vary without notice between units, displays, or software states.

4.2 SYMBOL COLUMN TABLE

Column A	Column B	Column C	Column D	Column E	Column F
Hollow Star	Cursive Q	Trident	Spiral Eye	Hooked Arrow	Double Diamond
Forked Rune	Broken Circle	Ladder Glyph	Hollow Star	Crescent Loop	Trident
Spiral Eye	Double Diamond	Cursive Q	Crown Symbol	Forked Rune	Spiral Eye
Crescent Loop	Crown Symbol	Broken Circle	Trident	Ladder Glyph	Cursive Q

4.3 ORDER DETERMINATION PROCEDURE

4.3.1 Locate the single column containing all four symbols present on the module. If more than one column appears superficially plausible, continue inspection until only one column contains all four without substitution, approximation, or wishful interpretation.

4.3.2 Once the matching column has been identified, press the keypad symbols in the order in which those symbols appear from top to bottom within that column. The keypad's own top-left, top-right, bottom-left, and bottom-right positions are irrelevant except insofar as they identify which button bears which symbol.

4.4 INCORRECT PRESS CONSEQUENCE

An incorrect press, including a correct symbol entered in the wrong position of the sequence, causes two effects: first, a strike is issued; second, the entered sequence resets. Thereafter the operator must recommence from the first symbol of the correct order. The correct lookup column does not change as a consequence of error.

MODULE 5 — SIMON SAYS

This module operates by means of chromatic response sequencing, a term which in administrative literature denotes the requirement that observed flashes be transformed, through a strike-dependent remapping scheme, into corresponding pad presses. The four pads are Red, Blue, Green, and Yellow. The visible sequence is therefore not necessarily the sequence to be entered, notwithstanding the unfortunate intuitive appeal of treating identical observation and response as interchangeable concepts.

5.1 SEQUENCE PROGRESSION

The module first presents a one-colour sequence, then a two-colour sequence, and thereafter successively longer sequences extended by one additional colour per completed round. The operator must reproduce the response sequence for the entire currently displayed round, not merely the newly appended element.

WARNING. Failure resets only the current round's input state. It does not erase the module's accumulated sequence history. Accordingly, after an error the operator must re-enter the full sequence for the present round as flashed, translated through the currently applicable remapping table.

5.2 STRIKE-DEPENDENT CHROMATIC CIPHER KEY

Flash Colour	0 Strikes — Press	1 Strike — Press	2 Strikes — Press
Red	Red	Blue	Yellow
Blue	Blue	Yellow	Green
Green	Green	Green	Red
Yellow	Yellow	Red	Blue

5.3 RESPONSE PROTOCOL

For each flashed colour in the displayed sequence, identify the colour observed, determine the current strike count, consult the cipher key above, and press the remapped colour. This translation must be performed separately for each element of the sequence, even where two consecutive flashes are identical.

5.4 FAILURE HANDLING

If a response error occurs, the operator shall await the repeated display of the current-round sequence, then retranslate and re-enter that entire round in order. No restart of earlier successfully completed rounds is required unless the module itself presents them as part of the now-longer current sequence, which it ordinarily will.

END OF MODULE DOCUMENTATION

Strict compliance with clause order is mandatory.